



My Brother's Wheelchair

Here We Go!

A. List three things that you can do well.

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

B. List any one thing that you find difficult to do.

Share your responses with your partner.



Remember, every person is different and unique. We look different, like different things and do things differently. That's what makes each one of us special!

Read about Dhrubo, who is in a wheelchair and his sister, Durva. You are about to read how much fun they have together.

Wheeeeeeeeeeee!

Here's me and my brother on his wheelchair.

Everyone who sees us,

Says we make a crazy pair.

He has painted both the wheels,
In blues, yellows and maroons.
And sometimes, just for fun,
He also ties balloons.

My brother's very smart,
He's got plenty of brains.
He helps me across puddles,
When it rains.

When we go to the park,
In the evening to play,
He uses a horn,
So people make way.

Going to the market with him,
Is such a treat.
He has a rear-view mirror,
For when we're on the street.

Sometimes he takes his chair
Into a shallow stream.
I give it a good splash.
Oh, how he does scream!



When **baba** and **aai** take us
To the hills for a **hike**,
He puts on special wheels—
Like a mountain bike!

All our friends wait,
For their turn to ride,
It feels so good,
With the arms out wide.

He goes so fast,
He is called the wheelchair **champ**.
And now all our friends know...
Their house must have a **ramp**!



—SALIL CHATURVEDI

Salil Chaturvedi is a writer, poet and disability activist. He has worked hard to raise awareness about access for disabled persons. He has acted in, and written for, the popular children's television serial *Galli Galli Sim Sim*, and produced *Shabduli*, the first Konkani book for visually impaired persons. He has three collections of poetry and a collection of short stories to his credit.



To read more poems by Salil Chaturvedi, you can scan the QR code:





Do You Know?

- Kamala Kanta Nayak holds the world record for travelling the most distance in a wheelchair in 24 hours.
- The Stoke Mandeville Games was the first ever Paralympic game organised by Dr Guttman in the UK.



Words to Know

Wheeeeeeeeeeee!

1-2-3-4-5-6-7-8-9-0-1-2

a sound made by someone to express enjoyment

baba

father (in many Indian languages)

aai

mother (Maharashtra)

hike

a long walk, especially for pleasure or exercise

ramp

a slope or an incline used instead of stairs



About the Poem

A. Tick (✓) the correct option.

1. The speaker is a young _____.

a. girl

☒

b. boy

☐

c. woman

☐

2. The two children _____.

a. do not play together

☐

b. have fun together

☒

c. cannot play the same games

☐

3. The boy likes to _____.

a. not go to the park to play

☐

b. decorate his wheelchair

☒

c. play with balloons in the park

☐

4. The boy gets people to move out of the way by _____.
 - a. telling them to move away ☐
 - b. shouting 'Wheeeeeee!' ☐
 - c. blowing a horn ☒
5. A rear-view mirror is one that is _____.
 - a. placed at the back of the wheelchair ☐
 - b. a mirror that is there in Baba's car to see the children ☐
 - c. used by the driver to see the traffic behind ☒

B. Why do you think Durva and Bhrubo are close? Why are they called 'a crazy pair'?

C. Words are said to rhyme together when they have the same sound at the end.

Read the following rhyming words aloud.

tree – free

tent – bent

train – drain

chain – rain

change – range

ball – tall

Find and write pairs of rhyming words from the poem in your notebook.

Real-life Connect



Think of ways we can support and be good friends to classmates who might have special needs, just like the brother in the poem.

Let's Connect



The Paralympic Games are held every two years. Find out about one event that is held during the Paralympic Games.